literary values" (de Bruijn 1983: 119). Given *Hadiqat*'s homiletic *genre* and overall structure – didactic poetry paired with illustrative prose anecdotes – further juxtaposition with the Pali Buddhist canon may aid in dispelling the current confusion around its complex form. Cf. de Bruijn 1983, 119–163; de Bruijn, "Sana'i" *EIr* (2012); and Lewis 1995, 112–120. Indeed, such an interdisciplinary juxtaposition could also be fruitful for questions regarding the specific Buddhist texts that circulated throughout historical Bactria, and these texts' audiences and receptions.

5. Twelfth-century inhabitants of the regions within modern Afghanistan were surrounded by remnants of Buddhist monasteries and other structures. According to Melikian-Chirvani (1974: esp. 34ff., 64–65), certain "stereotypes" with identifiably Buddhist literary origins had also filtered into Persian poetry. While Lewis (1995: 120) concluded that Sana'i was the first Persian poet to have introduced the elephant parable into Persian poetry and literature (see note *supra*), the specific mechanisms by which Sana'i accessed the contents of Buddhist literature – was he versed in Pali, and were manuscripts available in Ghazna or accessible in the region? – are still to be determined. Alternatively, the poet might have made use of an *already* translated Persian version, in which case he would not have been the first Persian poet to integrate the parable in his œuvre.
6. I borrow the phrasing from Peacock's (2010: 3) important study on the early Saljuqs.
7. Aside from Ghaznavid-issued coinage – including the well-known Kufic-Sharada *dirham*s and figural *jital*s, the latter continuing in the Panjab for several centuries – no surviving architectural remains farther east in the *duab* region are known. Cf. R. Tye and M. Tye 1995: 43 and nos. 86, 89, 91–94.
8. Cf., e.g., Rosenfield 1967/1993: 41–54; also Ball, Bordeaux et al. 2019: 345. The convergence of Greek, Iranian, and Indian "symbols of power and victory" in Kushana iconography underscored the regular traffic of people from all of Eurasia's major cultural regions within Kushana-affiliated territories. Additionally, among the legacies of the Kushana period would be the coalescence of the anthropomorphic iconographies of Buddhism, which was to have enduring effects on the religio-cultural lives of peoples across Eurasia for centuries to come. Cf. Pons, "Kushan Dynasty ix. Art of the Kushans," *EIr* (2016).
9. I have found the recent engagements by Green (2019) and Spooner (2019) with the "Persianate" – with some modifications (cf. Chapter 1) – as a heuristic useful for delineating the process of attaining kingship that the Shansabanis undertook.
10. See, e.g., Patel 2010 for an overview of textual sources indicating seventh–eighth-century presence of Muslim communities in South Asia; cf. also Asif 2016: 13. The Shansabanis' north Indian activity is the principal subject of Volume II.
11. The origins of this catch-all rubric have been attributed to early twentieth-century scholarship on India (cf. Patel 2018: esp. 60) and the singularity of the term "Sultanate" in the face of the multiplicity of these polities and their